

INDIA BATTLES STROKE EPIDEMIC

National Stroke Conclave and Awards Focus on Transforming Care

New Delhi, November 30, 2024 – Stroke has become a growing health crisis in India, with more than 1.8 million new cases annually, making it one of the leading causes of disability and death in the country. The condition imposes a significant emotional and financial burden on patients and their families while underscoring critical gaps in healthcare infrastructure, awareness, and timely treatment. Recognizing the urgent need for comprehensive solutions, the 2nd Edition of the National Stroke Conclave and Awards, organized by Voice of Healthcare (VOH), Endorsed & Supported by the Indian Stroke Association (ISA) and presented by Marengo Asia Hospitals took place on November 30, 2024, at the Hyatt Regency, New Delhi.

This landmark event brought together India's top neurologists, policymakers, healthcare professionals, and innovators to collaborate on improving stroke prevention, acute care, and rehabilitation. The event's centerpiece was the Stroke Innovation & Excellence Awards, which honors individuals and organizations responsible for transforming stroke care in India.

The day's proceedings started with an Inaugural Session featuring opening remarks by **Dr. Naveen Nishchal Founder Chairman of Voice of Healthcare and co-founder of Medo-Doxper and Cygnus Hospital** "Stroke remains one of the most pressing yet preventable health challenges in India. With over 12 lakh deaths annually, it's crucial to address awareness, timely treatment, and preventive measures, especially hypertension control. Together, through collaborative efforts in education, infrastructure, and policy, we can transform stroke care and create a lasting impact," followed by addresses from eminent speakers such as **Dr. Jeyaraj Pandian, President of the World Stroke Organization** "It's a great moment for all the delegates gathered here for the second edition of the VOH Stroke Conclave. While we face the challenge of limited resources to manage the growing number of stroke patients, we must ask how we can ensure equitable services. The WHO emphasizes stroke surveillance as a priority, yet the struggle lies in gathering reliable data on mortality and addressing variations across regions. A comprehensive approach that includes rehabilitation and prevalence programs, both locally and globally, is critical to transforming stroke care and outcomes."



Dr. Raajiv Singhal, Founding Member, Managing Director, and Group CEO shared his view "The current landscape of stroke in India highlights both challenges and opportunities, with the condition being a significant cause of mortality and disability. Rapid urbanization, changing lifestyles, and a growing burden of risk factors like hypertension, diabetes, and obesity have significantly increased stroke incidence, especially among the younger population. Despite advances in medical science, timely access to specialized care remains a challenge, compounded by inadequate awareness and insufficient infrastructure in rural and semi-urban areas. Reaching the right hospital, at the right time is the essence of treatment.